

Masyhur A. Hilmy

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Employment and Affiliations

Lecturer, University of New South Wales	2023-present
Invited Researcher, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) J-PAL Southeast Asia	2023-present
Research Manager (2016-17), Sr. Research Associate (2015), Research Associate (2014)	
Teacher, Indonesia Mengajar	2012-2013

Education

PhD, Economics, Boston University, United States	2023
MSc, Astronomy, Kyoto University, Japan	2012
BSc, Astronomy, Institut Teknologi Bandung, Indonesia	2009

Working Papers

International Migration, Exchange Rate Shocks, and Education Investment. Revise and resubmit at *the Economic Journal*.

Screen Set Size and Charitable Giving: A Field Experiment on a Peer-to-Peer Online Donation Platform (with G. Lim and Y. E. Riyanto). Revise and resubmit at *Management Science*.

It Takes a Village Election: Turnover and Performance in Local Bureaucracies (with S. Bazzi, B. Marx, M. Shaukat, and A. Stegmann)

Linking Vocational Schools to Industry: Effects on Teachers in Indonesia (with C. Garro-Marín)

Expanding Access in a Semi-Public Education Market: Evidence from a Large High School Expansion (with C. Garro-Marín)

Publications

Religion, Education, and the State (with S. Bazzi and B. Marx). *Review of Economic Studies*, 2025.

Education for the Masses or the Pious? Public and Islamic Schools in Indonesia (with S. Bazzi and B. Marx). In D. Rohner and E. Zhuravskaya (eds.). *Nation Building: Big Lessons from Successes and Failures*. Paris, France: CEPR Press. 2023

The Impact of Sending Top College Graduates to Rural Primary Schools. *Journal of Southeast Asian Economies*, 2023.

Research in Progress

Changing Norms of Corruption Among Future Public Servants? (with S. Bazzi, B. Marx, M. Shaukat, and A. Stegmann)

Demand Effects in the Field (with S. Bazzi, B. Marx, M. Shaukat, and A. Stegmann)

Colonial Education Investments in the Long Run: Evidence from the Netherlands Indies.

Grants and Awards

Kemendikdasmen-KONEKSI, Localization of National Competency Based Exams, with M. Pradhan, C. Brown, D. Halim, S. Leuthold, and A. Aditomo, 2026.

J-PAL Southeast Asia Inclusive Financial Innovation Initiative (IFII) Exploratory Study, Credit Abundance and Online Gambling in Indonesia, with T. Arundina and A. Shonchoy, 2025.

BU Department of Economics, Rosenstein-Rodan Essay Prize runner-up, 2022

J-PAL Governance Initiative and J-PAL Southeast Asia IRF Grant, Building State Capacity at Scale, with S. Bazzi, B. Marx, M. Shaukat, and A. Stegmann, 2021

BU Institute for Economic Development, The Determinants of Altruism, with G. Lim and Y. E. Riyanto, 2021

Weiss Fund and J-PAL Southeast Asia IRF Grant, Improving the Link between Vocational Schools and Industry, with C. Garro-Marín, 2020-2021

Duolingo Language Impact Award, 2021

World Bank Knowledge for Change Program, Institutional Strengthening for Improved Village Service Delivery, with S. Bazzi, Y. Herawati, B. Marx, A. O'Donnell, L. Ralston, M. Shaukat, and A. Stegmann, 2020

Weiss Fund, Exploratory Fieldwork for Research on Education in Indonesia, 2019

BU Institute for Economic Development, Manuel Abdala grant, 2019

Japanese Government Scholarship, 2009-2012

Presentations (*co-author presentation; ^ scheduled; + discussant)

2026: ANU^

2025: U Sydney, U Melbourne, Deakin University, Macquarie, UNSW STEP UP, U Indonesia, LETSS Talk webinar, Kartini Conference on Indonesian Feminisms.

2024: BREAD at NUS, Australian Political Economy Network Workshop (U. Sydney), ACE (U. Adelaide), Australasian Development Economic Workshop (U. Melbourne), UNSW STEP UP+, Australian Cliometrics Workshop+.

2023: NUS (Economics, Public Policy), UNSW, Monash, Macquarie, INSEAD, Gottingen.

2022: NEUDC

2021: NBER Economics of Culture and Institutions Spring Meeting*; AIFIS Michigan State Univ.; WIDER Dev Conference United Nations University; ADB Institute; NEUDC*

2020: CILIS Univ. of Melbourne; NBER Development Economics Summer Institute*, NEUDC*; J-PAL SEA Brown Bag Seminar

2019: BU GEA Spring Poster Session

2017: Raskin Reform Inter-ministerial Meeting (Ministry of Development Planning);

2016: Australian Centre for International Agricultural Research Workshop (Bandung); Sustainable Coffee Platform of Indonesia/SCOPI Workshop (Jakarta)

2015: Indonesia Regional Studies Association (Universitas Udayana)

2014: Social Security Agency for Health/BPJS Kesehatan

Teaching

2026: ECON5310 Development Economics, ECON 4205/7205 Microeconometrics (UNSW)

2025: ECON5101 Microeconomics (UNSW), ECON 4205/7205 Microeconometrics (UNSW)

2024: ECON5101 Microeconomics (UNSW), ECON 4205/7205 Microeconometrics (UNSW)

2022: EC320 Economics of Less-Developed Regions (Instructor, Boston University)

EC101 OL Introduction to Microeconomics

2021: EC101 Introductory Microeconomic Analysis (Teaching Fellow, Boston University)

2017: J-PAL SEA Course, Introduction to Evaluations and Randomized Evaluations (Teaching Facilitator, Univ. Indonesia)

2016: J-PAL SEA Course, Evaluating Social Program (Teaching Facilitator, Univ. Indonesia)

2015: J-PAL SEA Course, Evaluating Social Program (Teaching Facilitator, Univ. Gadjah Mada); Mixed Methods Research Training Workshop (Bappenas/Ministry of Development Planning); Regional Development Planning Agency Training (LPEM UI)

2012-2013: Trans Batui 5 Public Elementary School, (Grade 4-5 teacher, Banggai, Indonesia)

Service

Referee: American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Labor Economics, Labour Economics, Economic Modelling, Singapore Economic Review, Journal of Law and Economics, Fiscal Studies, International Journal of Public Opinion Research

Mentorship: AEA CSQIEP Conference (2023), GAIN/Graduate Application International Network (2021, 2023), Indonesia Mengglobal (2021, 2023), Boston Partners in Education (2019-2020)

Activities

Queer Indonesia Archive, volunteer, 2020

Duolingo Incubator, volunteer, developed a free online Indonesian course (1.07M active users) and an English course (4.71M active users), 2014-2019.

Programming Skills: Stata, Mata, R, Matlab, IDL, Fortran, LaTeX, Git.

Languages: English (fluent), Indonesian (native), Javanese, Japanese (basic).